

## SDG Goal 4      Quality education

**SDG Target 4.b**      By 2020, substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available to developing countries, in particular least developed countries, small island developing States and African countries, for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes, in developed countries and other developing countries

**SDG Indicator 4.b.1**      Volume of official development assistance flows for scholarships

**Time series**      Commitments and gross disbursements of Official Development Assistance for scholarships and imputed student costs

### 1. General information on the time series

- Date of national metadata: June 15, 2026
- National data: <https://sdg-indicators.de/4-b-1>
- Definition: The time series shows Germany's commitments and gross disbursements of Official Development Assistance (ODA) for scholarships and imputed student costs.
- Disaggregation: Purpose, Type of Official Development Assistance

### 2. Comparability with the UN metadata

- Date of UN metadata: December 2025
- UN metadata: <https://unstats.un.org/sdgs/metadata/files/Metadata-04-0B-01.pdf>

Note: The indicator refers to developing countries, of which Germany is not a member.

- The time series is not compliant with the UN metadata, but provides additional information. The reasons are as follows:
  - o It shows Germany's ODA, while the UN metadata provides information on the development assistance received from the perspective of developing countries.
  - o The UN metadata does not specify the necessary purposes and/or types of assistance.

### 3. Data description

- According to the OECD, ODA is government support that is specifically “designed to promote the economic and social development of developing countries.”

ODA is an internationally recognised measure agreed within the OECD Development Assistance Committee (DAC). It comprises financial flows provided by official agencies to developing countries, their nationals, or international organisations for the benefit of developing countries. Private contributions and charitable donations are not recorded as ODA.

The DAC List of ODA Recipients is generally revised every three years by the DAC on the basis of the World Bank income classifications.

4. Access to data source

- OECD – ODA for scholarships and imputed student costs [Selections: DAC1: Flows by provider (ODA+OOF+Private); Measure: 1510, 1520; Flow type: Disbursements, Commitments]:

[https://data-explorer.oecd.org/?fs\[0\]=Topic%2C1%7CDevelopment%23DEV%23%7COfficial%20Development%20Assistance%20%28ODA%29%23DEV\\_ODA%23&pg=0&fc=Topic&bp=true&snb=20](https://data-explorer.oecd.org/?fs[0]=Topic%2C1%7CDevelopment%23DEV%23%7COfficial%20Development%20Assistance%20%28ODA%29%23DEV_ODA%23&pg=0&fc=Topic&bp=true&snb=20)

5. Metadata on source data

- General information about ODA:

<https://www.oecd.org/en/topics/official-development-assistance-oda.html>

- List of the OECD DAC purpose codes and channel codes:

<https://development-finance-codelists.oecd.org/CodesList.aspx>

- DAC list of ODA Recipients:

<https://www.oecd.org/en/topics/sub-issues/oda-eligibility-and-conditions/dac-list-of-oda-recipients.html#oda-recipients-list>

6. Timeliness and frequency

- Timeliness: t + 11 months
- Frequency: Annual

7. Calculation method

- Unit of measurement: Million EUR; Million USD, constant prices
- Calculation: Not applicable.